

Velocity Verdict: read the change, not the count.

A one-page screen for public GitHub engineering activity. Use it to spot meaningful acceleration, rule out obvious noise, and decide what deserves a closer look.

14 days

Compare the current window with the same team's prior baseline.

21 to 47 days

Observed lead-time IQR before public fundraise announcements in the documented panel.

219 observations

Startup-period observations across 55 startups and five quarters.

THE THREE-SIGNAL SCREEN

One metric can lie. A coordinated change is harder to dismiss.

SIGNAL 01

Velocity surge

Is the team shipping more than its own recent normal? Read the delta, not the lifetime total or a single busy day.

SIGNAL 02

Contributor breadth

Is the work spreading across more people? A broad team change carries more information than one noisy maintainer.

SIGNAL 03

Infrastructure buildout

Are new repos, services, or release surfaces appearing? Look for systems that support a larger product or customer load.

Slow down when you see:

- ✗ One account created most of the change.
- ✗ The spike is docs, formatting, vendored code, or bot traffic.
- ✗ Activity lasted one day and immediately returned to baseline.
- ✗ The company is fully closed-source or the public repo is not its core work.

The five-minute workflow

1. SCAN

Compare the last 14 days with the prior team baseline.

2. VERIFY

Check breadth, persistence, and what actually changed.

3. ACT

Write one specific observation and ask one clear question.



THE ONE QUESTION

What changed in the last 14 days that did not exist in this team's prior 90-day baseline?